As he had so many times over the eight years, Mark Weinberg of the press office then brought in a group of photographers for one last photo.

They left, and I was alone again in the Oval Office. I got up and started to walk out. When I was halfway through the door, I turned around and took one last look at the Oval Office. Then I was gone.

I walked back to the family quarters, where soon it was time for Nancy and me to say good-bye to the White House staff who had looked after us for eight years, everyone from the ushers and gardeners to the plumbers and chefs.

A few minutes later, George and Barbara Bush and Dan and Marilyn Quayle arrived at the White House, along with the congressional leaders who were going to escort us to the inauguration.

At eleven, we left for the Capitol and a ride up Pennsylvania Avenue. At noon, George Bush was inaugurated as the forty-first president of the United States. After he finished his inaugural address and our part in the ceremonies was over, George and Barbara walked Nancy and me under the great dome of the Capitol to where a helicopter was waiting east of the building. And from there we headed home.